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COURSE -BA P POLITICAL SCIENCE + HINDI

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BOOKREVIEW

Name of the book : Why I Am an Atheist and Other Works

Author - Bhagat Singh

Published - 2021

Language - English

Genre - NON fiction

Theme - Rationalism vs. Blind Faith

Review of Why I Am an Atheist and Other Works by Bhagat Singh

This book is full of Bhagat Singh's own writings his essays, letters from jail, court statements, and messages. Reading his own words feels very special, you know? It gives you a real look inside his mind and

heart.

The book is a collection of his thoughts written by himself. Most of it has letters, replies to editorials, and statements he made. It tells about how he and his friends got involved in the Saunders murder case, the Assembly bombing, their life in jail, the hunger strike, and all the demands they made. When you read it, you clearly understand what was really going on in their minds during those difficult times. It is not like a movie or a film director explaining things. This is Bhagat Singh ji speaking directly to you.

The most important and powerful part of the book is the main essay "Why I Am an Atheist". He wrote this in October 1930 while he was in Lahore Central Jail, waiting for his hanging. In this essay, Bhagat Singh explains very honestly why he does not believe in God. His arguments are clear, strong, and come from deep thinking.

His main arguments are these:

First, if God is all-powerful and kind, then why is the world full of so much pain, poverty, suffering, wars, and injustice? Why does God allow innocent

people to suffer while bad people keep exploiting others? If God can do everything, why doesn't He stop all the troubles?

Second, all religions say they are the only true one but they fight with each other and tell completely different stories about God and afterlife. This proves that religions are made by humans, not by any God.

Third, he says religion is like opium for the masses. It gives poor people false hope of heaven and stops them from fighting for real change in this world. It makes people passive and dependent on God instead of using their own reason and taking action.

He also shares his personal story. As a child he was religious and prayed a lot, but after reading many books and seeing the suffering of common people, he became an atheist through logic and experience, not because of ego or pride. Some people said he became atheist because of fame after the bomb case, but he completely rejects that.

The main research question of this essay is: Does belief in God help human progress or does it become a big

hindrance in the way of reason, courage, development, and revolution? His clear answer is it becomes a huge hindrance.

The whole book asks some bigger research

1. Why should we reject blind belief in God and religion if we want real progress in society?

2. What is the true meaning of revolution is it only getting freedom from British rule or bringing a complete socialist change where there is equality for everyone?

3. How can young people build a better, fair, and equal India based on reason, science, education, justice, and socialism instead of superstition, casteism, and old traditions?

This book really shows another side of Bhagat Singh's personality that is not commonly discussed. He was not just a warrior with guns and bombs. He was a profound thinker. His struggle was not based only on emotions but on logic, study, and deep understanding. He read a lot Marx, Lenin, Bakunin, and many other writers. He believed that true revolution is first a revolution of thoughts. He once wrote that the sword of revolution is sharper when it is

based on the edge of ideas. He wanted people to free their minds from superstition and mental slavery.

In his jail letters and writings, you can see his intellectual curiosity very clearly. He kept thinking and writing about Marxism, socialism, and what real freedom means even when he was in prison. He was opposed to religious fanaticism and casteism. He dreamed of an India that is free not only from the British but also from economic and social inequality. He wanted a society where everyone is equal, where poor people are not exploited, and where reason and science are more important than blind faith.

His atheism was not about despair or sadness. For him, atheism meant freedom from superstition, mental slavery, and fear. He valued reason, science, and human responsibility more than God. He believed that humans should take responsibility for their own destiny instead of waiting for divine help. This idea comes again and again in his writings.

One thing that impressed me a lot is how he explains the ideological basis of the revolution. He was a socialist revolutionary. When he shouted "Inquilab

"Zindabad", it was not only about Indian independence. It meant a deep Marxist socialist revolution like Lenin did in Russia. Indian independence was only a small part of his bigger dream. He wanted to completely change Indian society, end exploitation, bring equality, and give power to the common people, peasants, and workers.

From his letters, you can see he wanted the youth of India to form a Communist Party with a military wing to bring this change. He was proud of his party, the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association. He knew many people were against his ideas, but he stayed firm because he believed strongly in humanity and justice.

The British were scared of him and his comrades because they were not ordinary freedom fighters. They were seen as Marxist socialist revolutionaries and were called terrorists. Bhagat Singh replied boldly, "If you call me a terrorist, fine, but I consider myself a revolutionary." The British made them martyrs because they refused to stay quiet and kept spreading radical ideas even in jail.

Reading this book also made me think why Gandhi and

Nehru did not fully support Bhagat Singh. It feels like they acted as a safety valve for the British when public anger was too high. Bhagat Singh's radical ideas were a bigger threat to the system, so he was opposed.

Let's be honest, after reading I have mixed feelings. Bhagat Singh's courage and clarity are amazing. His atheism chapter is very strong and well-written. Even today, his arguments about suffering and God are hard to ignore. But looking at later history, full socialism did not turn out as perfect as he hoped. It often took away freedom of speech and did not allow opposition. If he were alive today, he might have understood the problems that came with it.

Still, this book inspires young people even today. It tells us to overcome our inner fears and superstitions and take responsibility for society. Bhagat Singh believed that true freedom is possible only when people change their thinking. His writings show that a revolutionary has to give up personal life completely for the bigger cause. He studied and wrote even in jail. He demanded better conditions for political prisoners right to read books and newspapers, no hard

labour, etc. All these demands are written in his own letters.

If you have even a little interest in history, freedom struggle, or Bhagat Singh, you should definitely read this book. It will fill a gap in your knowledge. You will understand exactly what Bhagat Singh himself thought about life, God, revolution, and India's future. It is straightforward and honest. Reading his own words feels completely different from watching movies.

Three major points stood out for me after reading:

1. Bhagat Singh was a deep thinker and socialist revolutionary, not just a fighter.
2. His atheism was based on logic, observation of suffering, and love for humanity.
3. He believed real revolution starts in the mind; changing thoughts is more important than anything else.

This book tells another side of Bhagat Singh's personality: his intellectual depth, his passion for equality, and his fearless honesty. It inspires me to question things, think logically, and stand for justice.